



TWELVE-MONTH PROGRESS REPORT

Nigeria: progress report, 2025-08-01 to 2026-08-04

Edition of 2026-08-13 · 211 systems and instruments tracked, 7 of them not held

Compiled 2026-08-10 from the Data Landscapers source base. Sections follow the status report. Each opens with a movement ledger comparing the position at the start and end of the period, which runs to the date of issue rather than to the last month's close.

Of 211 systems and instruments on this place's ledger, 123 changed position between 2025-08-01 and 2026-08-04, 53 did not, 20 carry no stated baseline, and 7 are **Not held** at both ends. A further 8 took a position dated after 2026-08-04 and are carried in the status report rather than compared here.

Shape check, run before the comparison: 502 sources for this place in the window — 89 in the earlier half (2025-08 to 2026-01), 413 in the later (2026-02 to 2026-08). The earlier half of the window is thin: this is a shorter comparison wearing a longer label, and the movement below rests mostly on the later half.

Movement values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

Summary of the period

Nearly four times as many sources sit in the later half of this window as in the earlier, so arrival counts measure coverage as much as construction.

No system climbed a maturity band, and every system that changed band went backwards. Satellite broadband regressed, its largest provider pausing new orders over congestion and then brought inside a biometric verification regime; the retail central bank digital currency is under review and being redesigned toward a wholesale model; and enforcement of the new internet-platform rules was paused pending a unified framework. One programme stalled — 260 state schools whose January 2026 completion date passed with many incomplete.

Everything else arrived or held. Nigeria's digital state was substantially built before the window opened.

The same year produced a data-localisation directive, a virtual-assets executive order, a crypto tax circular, an identity statute, an open-banking launch and a three-year payments vision.

Infrastructure

Connectivity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
IFC financing for Airtel Africa network upgrades	Did not exist	US\$150m for network upgrades	ADVANCED
Mobile and broadband subscriber base	50% broadband penetration (2025-11)	157m internet subscribers (2026-05), from 154.3m (2026-04); 188m mobile subscriptions and broadband penetration 55.67% (2026-04)	ADVANCED
MTN 400G and 800G optical backbone with Huawei	Did not exist	400G and 800G optical backbone with Huawei	ADVANCED
MTN acquisition of IHS Towers	Did not exist	Acquisition under federal strategic review	ADVANCED
MTN fibre-to-the-home programme	Did not exist	In build against an 8m-home target for 2028	ADVANCED
NCC network performance reporting with Ookla	Did not exist	Two editions of crowdsourced urban and rural measurement published	ADVANCED
Nigeria-Equatorial Guinea subsea cable	Did not exist	Cable bundled with a commercial data centre	ADVANCED
Project BRIDGE national open-access fibre	Announced (2025-05)	US\$1.6bn World Bank-appraised envelope, superseding the ~US\$2bn announced 2025-05-18; SPV due to incorporate by 2026-07-31 with private investors at 51-75% and the state at 25-49%; physical deployment expected to start 2027 toward ~120,000 km of backbone by 2030	ADVANCED
Protection of telecom infrastructure from vandalism and access denial	Baseline not held	155,397 fibre cuts in April-May 2026 alone (74,276 April, 79,121 May), more than 54,000 attributed to vandalism	REGRESSED
Removal of the 5% telecom excise duty	5% excise in force	Removed	ADVANCED
Spectrum Roadmap 2026-2030	Did not exist	Assignable IMT spectrum to rise from 1.07 GHz to about 3.8 GHz by 2030, against targets of at least 96% 4G population coverage and at least 50% for 5G	ADVANCED
9mobile national roaming on MTN	Live (2025-05)	Roaming live; T2 Mobile flat at 802,534 internet subscribers (2026-05), no visible recovery	NO CHANGE
Internet Exchange Point of Nigeria traffic	1 Tbps (2025-04)	Above 1 Tbps	NO CHANGE
Mobile broadband population coverage	4G LTE 84.60% and 5G 13.28% of population (2024-12)	4G about 85% and 5G about 13% of population (2025), against 2030 targets of at least 96% and at least 50%	NO CHANGE
Sweden network quality-of-experience project	Running (2025-02)	Running	NO CHANGE
Telecom tariff reset	In force (2025-01)	In force; the first rise in about 11 years	NO CHANGE
Airtel Nigeria retail and distribution network	BASILINE NOT HELD	About 17,200 sites, from about 13,000 three years earlier	Baseline not held
Utilisation of the deployed fibre backbone	BASILINE NOT HELD	About 101,000 km built, bypassing some 130m Nigerians (2026-07)	Baseline not held

Data Storage

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
1Government sovereign cloud	Did not exist	GovDrive, GovMail, GovECMS and GovE-Sign across ministries	ADVANCED
Airtel Nxtra Eko Atlantic data centre	Did not exist	Planned 38 MW GPU-ready build, over US\$120m	ADVANCED
Cassava National Sovereign Cloud	Did not exist	In service	ADVANCED
Digital Realty LKK2 Lagos data centre	Did not exist	In service	ADVANCED
Equinix LG3 Lagos build	Did not exist	In build	ADVANCED
Fringe Ikoyi Metro EDGE facility	Did not exist	In service	ADVANCED
Kasi Cloud LOS1 hyperscale campus	Did not exist	US\$250m campus scaling toward about 100 MW	ADVANCED
Subsidised sovereign cloud for startups	Did not exist	Subsidised sovereign cloud for startups	ADVANCED
AWS naira billing	In force (2025-01)	Naira billing; the nearest region is Cape Town	NO CHANGE
MTN Sifiso Dabengwa data centre	Live (2025-07)	4.5 MW Tier III, 780 racks and a naira-priced cloud	NO CHANGE
Open Access Data Centres Lagos expansion	In build (2025-03)	To 24 MW by 2027, about US\$240m	NO CHANGE
Visa Nigeria data centre	Planned (2025-03)	Planned	NO CHANGE
Commercial data-centre estate	BASELINE NOT HELD	About 26 facilities, 50-56 MW live against about 124 MW installed (2026-07)	Baseline not held

Energy

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Grid supply to the data-centre estate	BASELINE NOT HELD	The grid has never reliably exceeded 6 GW for about 230m people, roughly 41% availability	Baseline not held

Cybersecurity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Ministerial Advisory Council on Cybersecurity	Did not exist	Announced, with no membership or terms of reference published	ADVANCED
Payment Security Operations Centre	Did not exist	Proposed; no legal basis, funding line or operator named	ADVANCED
Domestic cyber-insurance market	Forming (2025-02)	Still forming	NO CHANGE
Nigeria Police Force National Cybercrime Centre	Operating (2025-01)	₦8.82bn recovered and 751+ arrests in 2024	NO CHANGE

Data Exchange

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
NCC and Rural Electrification Agency data-sharing MoU	Did not exist	Electrification and universal-service deployment data overlaid	ADVANCED

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Cybercrimes (Amendment) Act 2024	In force (2024)	In force; lawyers argue it is misapplied against dissent	NO CHANGE

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
National Telecommunications Policy rewrite	Did not exist	First rewrite since 2000, in drafting	ADVANCED

Standards

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
End of pre-registered SIM cards	Did not exist	Practice ended	ADVANCED
National Cloud Computing and Technical Guidelines	Did not exist	Signed and in force in NITDA's framing, with implementation beginning immediately in phases and scope, obligations and thresholds unstated because no text is published	ADVANCED
National Digital Infrastructure Assurance Framework	Did not exist	Signed, with no published text and no stated assurance obligations, thresholds or commencement date	ADVANCED
National Software Quality Assurance Framework	Did not exist	Tiered risk with WCAG 2.1 AA for citizen-facing platforms; not adopted	ADVANCED

US / hyperscaler activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
United States fibre and feasibility grants	In place (2025-01)	US\$2m toward the 90,000 km build	NO CHANGE

China activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
21st Century and China Mobile sovereign cloud	Did not exist	A sovereignty push riding partly on a Chinese stack	ADVANCED

EU activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
EU-Nigeria Digital Economy Package	Did not exist	€45m	ADVANCED
Finland-Nigeria cyber and digitalisation MoU	Did not exist	MoU signed	ADVANCED

Research institutions

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
National Cybersecurity Centre, Bayero University Kano	Operating (2025-05)	Operating	NO CHANGE

Rural digital data capture

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Rural connectivity programmes	Baseline not held	About 3,700 towers to start deploying around October 2026 against 23% of rural communities connected (2025-10)	ADVANCED

Use of satellite data

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Amazon Kuiper landing permit	Did not exist	Permit granted; no service	ADVANCED
Starlink Nigeria service	Second-largest ISP by subscribers	Orders paused over congestion, later reopened	REGRESSED
NASRDA direct-to-device satellite programme	Announced (2025-06)	MoU with technology transfer and engineer training; no deployment	NO CHANGE
NigComSat and Eutelsat LEO partnership	Announced (2025-01)	Planned; no service	NO CHANGE

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Domestic bond financing of a fibre build	Did not exist	₦4.05bn of a ₦20bn programme; trivial against the donor and DFI lines	ADVANCED

Satellite broadband regressed. The largest provider had become Nigeria's second-largest ISP on Q4 2024 figures; by September 2025 it had paused new orders over congestion, and by December [more than 66,000 of its users](#) were required to submit an identity number and headshot under a regime built for SIM cards.

What arrived: a rebased optical backbone, a landing permit for a second satellite constellation, a hyperscale campus at Lekki, four sovereign-cloud initiatives, a cyber resilience framework with four-hour incident reporting, and the removal of the 5% telecom excise duty.

The national fibre programme was in development on 2025-08-01 and is in development now. The data-centre estate held its position while the localisation deadline that will test it was set. And the grid behind both has no dated position at either end that the base can state, and the localisation deadline falls on 2027-01-01.

Digital public infrastructure

Technical Capacity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
NIMC platform capacity for compulsory NIN use	BASELINE NOT HELD	Servers, databases and networks not sized for compulsory NIN use across 14 sectors	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Cybersecurity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Synthetic identity fraud	BASELINE NOT HELD	AI-generated identity fraud up 192% in Q1 2025 as document forgery fell 80%	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Data Exchange

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Bilateral MDA integration agreements under the NIMC Act	Did not exist	Nine agencies took bilateral cover under the new Act	ADVANCED
CBN-NCC telecom identity risk management feed	Did not exist	Banks can check SIM-swap and recycled numbers; fraud fell 51% to ₦25.85bn in 2025	ADVANCED
Nigeria Data Exchange	Announced (2025-08)	In production behind the Government Service Portal; the lawful basis is not on record	ADVANCED
National Single Window	In build (2025-01)	Still in build	NO CHANGE
Integration of the identity register with other government databases	BASELINE NOT HELD	Described by practitioners as federated linkage on a shared identifier, not an integrated ecosystem	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Digital Identity and CRVS

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
ICAO Public Key Directory integration	Did not exist	Passport cryptographically verifiable at 111 member states' borders	ADVANCED
National Identification Number and the foundational identity register	About 120m registrations (2025-08)	136m against a target of 180m by 2026-12-31; about 100m still uncaptured	ADVANCED
NIMC as national root certification authority	Did not exist	NIMC holds the national root certification authority	ADVANCED
NIN integration with health insurance records	Did not exist	NIN tied to health insurance records	ADVANCED
V-Pass airport identity verification	Did not exist	NIN and face biometrics for security checks and boarding	ADVANCED
General Multipurpose Card	Announced (2025-01)	In development with NIBSS and AfriGo	NO CHANGE

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
NINAuth consent-based verification	Live (2025-05)	Consent-based verification	NO CHANGE

Digital Payments and Fintech

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Consumer trust in digital payments	123,918 fraud incidents (2021)	Fraud losses ₦25.85bn in 2025, down 51% year on year, on 67,518 incidents (2025), with fraud reporting down 34% in Q4 2025	ADVANCED, ON A FALLING REPORTING RATE
eNaira retail central bank digital currency	Retail CBDC in issue	Being redesigned toward a wholesale model	REGRESSED
FX Bureau de Change purchase tracker	Did not exist	Real-time or same-day reporting by every licensed bureau	ADVANCED
Licensing regime for fiat-collateralised stablecoins	Did not exist	A drafted issuer-licensing regime with reserve localisation; no instrument issued	ADVANCED
National Payment Stack	In build (2025-06)	ISO 20022 stack live with instant settlement	ADVANCED
NIBSS Instant Payments	US\$187bn (2024-08)	4.12bn transactions; rated the first African instant system of its class	ADVANCED
Open banking	Did not exist	First in Africa; consented data sharing across about 120m bank customers	ADVANCED
Stablecoin business-to-business settlement rails	Did not exist	1,500+ businesses across Nigeria and Kenya on dollar liquidity	ADVANCED
USSD end-user billing	Dispute unresolved	Billed to airtime at ₦6.98 per 120 seconds with opt-in	ADVANCED
Airtime credit lending	BASELINE NOT HELD	About 40m users (2026-08) on an industry sizing of ₦300-400bn a year (2026)	Baseline not held
Bank-owned fintech subsidiaries as payments infrastructure	BASELINE NOT HELD	Tier-one banks hold payments infrastructure inside the group rather than at arm's length	Baseline not held

Registries (population, land, address, etc.)

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Electronic civil registration and vital statistics	Platform in rollout (2025-11)	Nationwide; birth registration about 57% and death under 20%	ADVANCED
National alphanumeric digital postcode system	An intention with no date	A launch date of 2026-10-01 for a unique address per building, with integration to existing government identity databases to follow	ADVANCED
National Mortgage Registry	Did not exist	Ready for deployment; no launch date, custodian or data-protection basis stated	ADVANCED
National Electronic Assets Register	Live (2025-03)	Live	NO CHANGE
National Land Registration and Documentation Programme	In development (2025-03)	More than 90% of land unregistered	NO CHANGE

Sectoral management information systems (HMIS, EMIS, etc.)

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Customs Electronic Cargo Tracking System	Did not exist	GPS tracking replacing physical escort at a second command	ADVANCED
IPPIS human-resource modules	Did not exist	Biometric onboarding, payroll and workforce analytics across 508+ agencies	ADVANCED
NIN verification of agricultural programme beneficiaries	Did not exist	Planned, on a three-year subsidy taper	ADVANCED
National social register	19.7m households (2025-06)	19.7m households, from 13m	NO CHANGE
Nigeria Digital Health Architecture	BASELINE NOT HELD	Health information, health services and health insurance claims exchanges named as the integration target	Baseline not held

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Government Service Portal	In build (2025)	Piloting on a four-year KOICA project reported at US\$13m	ADVANCED
Supreme Court mandatory electronic filing and the National Case Management System	Did not exist	Electronic upload of processes and Records of Appeal compulsory, OCR-searchable and on standardised naming, behind the National Case Management System	ADVANCED
CBN DocFlow and the MDA naira payment solution	Live (2025-01)	Live	NO CHANGE
Treasury Management and Revenue Assurance System	Live (2025-03)	Automatic deduction and remittance across all agencies	NO CHANGE

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
7.5% VAT on electronic banking fees	Did not exist	7.5% VAT on electronic banking fees	ADVANCED
CBN payments data-localisation directive	Did not exist	Binding from 2027-01-01; no power sequencing published	ADVANCED
DEON digital consumer-lending regulations	In force (2025-07)	In force and enforced, with the WASPAN appeal before the Court of Appeal and the existing framework held in place by ministerial direction	ADVANCED, NOW UNDER APPEAL
Market-concentration caps and operational ring-fencing	Did not exist	25% of issuing against 15% of acquiring, on monthly market-share returns	ADVANCED
National Digital Economy and E-Governance Bill	Did not exist	Would elevate NITDA to a super regulator; overlap flagged by stakeholders	ADVANCED
NIMC Act 2026	Did not exist	Replaces the 2007 Act; the NIN made the foundational credential	ADVANCED
Presidential Executive Order on Virtual Assets Coordination	Did not exist	A Virtual Asset Council and Office with its secretariat at the central bank	ADVANCED
Virtual-asset tax framework	Did not exist	1.5% stamp duty withheld in the asset itself and remitted in the originating token	ADVANCED
Investments and Securities Act 2025 treatment of crypto	In force (2025-05)	Crypto inside the securities perimeter	NO CHANGE

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Payments System Vision 2028	Did not exist	A three-year horizon from 2025 baselines of ₦1.2 quadrillion in electronic transactions, carrying 2028 targets of 95% financial inclusion, 5m QR merchant outlets and a 70% cut in fraud losses	ADVANCED
National DPI framework and the 2027 services target	In development (2025-03)	Still in development against a 2027 target	NO CHANGE
Presidential Committee on DPI Implementation	Constituted (2025-05)	Operating	NO CHANGE

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
AfCFTA ADAPT cross-border DPI pilot	Pilot named (2025-11)	Nigeria, Kenya and Morocco the first pilots	ADVANCED
ECOWAS biometric identity card	Did not exist	In issue	ADVANCED
Onafriq and PAPSS wallet-based naira-to-Ghana payments	Did not exist	Wallet-based naira-to-Ghana payments in pilot	ADVANCED
PAPSS participation	BASELINE NOT HELD	About US\$3.7m for a half-year, on 3,246 transactions	Baseline not held

Standards

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Automated AML baseline standards	Did not exist	In force; the test shifts to governance, integration and explainability	ADVANCED
Crypto trade reporting tied to TIN and NIN	Did not exist	Trades reported against TIN and NIN, aligned to the OECD framework	ADVANCED
ISO 20022 migration and PoS geo-tagging	Migration under way (2025-08)	ISO 20022 with PoS geo-tagging	ADVANCED
Nigeria Government Enterprise Architecture	Did not exist	Hosted by Galaxy Backbone and piloted at four agencies	ADVANCED
Nigerian Digital Trustmark	Did not exist	In issue	ADVANCED
Draft DPI technical standards and the Nigerian DPI Centre	In draft (2025-04)	Still in draft	NO CHANGE

Access to services

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Ward-level enrolment drive	Did not exist	Free enrolment in every ward, targeting under-enrolled groups	ADVANCED
Diaspora Non-Resident BVN	Live (2025-05)	Remote diaspora onboarding	NO CHANGE
NIN-keyed consumer credit scoring	Proposed (2025-06)	Planned; consequences would extend to passport and licence renewal	NO CHANGE
Correction of errors in the identity register	BASELINE NOT HELD	Excludes the about 72% of adults without smartphones	Baseline not held

AI

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
GovGuide public-services chatbot	Did not exist	On Meta's Llama in English, Hausa, Igbo and Yoruba	ADVANCED
Mandated AI and machine-learning fraud detection	Did not exist	AI and machine-learning fraud detection made mandatory	ADVANCED
Service-Wise GPT for the federal civil service	Live (2025-02)	In service across the federal civil service	NO CHANGE

ICT Industry

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Telco mobile money	BASELINE NOT HELD	Revenue up about 132% in H1 2026, with one airtime-lending product suspended	Baseline not held

EU activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
cBrain F2 case-management platform	Did not exist	Deployed on an assurance that sovereign data stays in Nigeria	ADVANCED

Training and skills

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Diaspora health-workforce registry	Did not exist	A register standing on no stated legal basis	ADVANCED

Digitalisation of sub-national government

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Enugu smart green schools	260 schools announced (2024-02)	Still 260 schools announced, at about ₦1.3-1.5bn each	STALLED
Benue civil-service digital skilling	Running (2025-03)	40,000 civil servants	NO CHANGE
Kaduna compensation and valuation land system	Live (2025-02)	Live	NO CHANGE
Lagos digital house-numbering and addressing	Piloting (2025-06)	Piloting	NO CHANGE

National statistics

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Make Inclusive Data the Norm initiative	Did not exist	Widened from three countries to five	ADVANCED
Telecoms contribution to GDP	8.93% of GDP (Q2 2024)	9.19% of GDP (Q1 2026) for telecommunications and information services, within information and communication at 11.31% of GDP (Q1 2026)	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
First biometric population census	Planned (2025-03)	Planned; the last census was 2006	NO CHANGE

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
World Bank ID4D financing	Running (2024-12)	US\$430m; target raised from 148m to 180m	NO CHANGE
App-based retail securities trading	BASELINE NOT HELD	₦2.86tn of retail equity trading January-May 2026, up 138.76%, at 36.22% of activity	Baseline not held

Almost nothing in this section changed band.

The identity register held the same position throughout: implemented at the window's start and implemented now, with enrolment [rising from 123.9m to 136m](#) against a 180m target. What did enter the record is the statutory layer around it — the NIMC Act 2026, the root certification authority transfer, ICAO directory integration and the ward-level enrolment drive.

The national data exchange was announced in August 2025 and only began moving personal data in production in July 2026, behind the Government Service Portal; the lawful basis for that operation is not on record at either end.

The payments instruments issued in the window were [open banking](#), a national payment stack, automated anti-money-laundering standards, market-concentration caps and the [localisation directive](#) among them. The rails they govern held their positions throughout.

The one regression is the retail central bank digital currency, Africa's first, now under review and being redesigned toward a wholesale model with the Bank stating it is not abandoned.

Governance and regulation

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
FCCPC competition probe of platforms and AI firms	Did not exist	Competition law used against uncompensated AI training on Nigerian journalism	ADVANCED
Framework for Compensation of Consumers	Did not exist	Automatic airtime credit in listed local government areas, with the qualifying thresholds unpublished	ADVANCED
Internet-platform regulation	Rules in force	Enforcement paused pending a unified digital-economy policy framework	REGRESSED
NDPA amendment bill	Did not exist	Before the assembly	ADVANCED
Private enforcement of data-protection rights	Did not exist	₦15m general damages for marketing after consent was withdrawn	ADVANCED
Social-media local-presence bill	Before the assembly (2025-03)	Through a Senate committee public hearing and into public consultation, with organised support and organised opposition on the record	ADVANCED
FCCPC consumer-protection penalty against Meta	Imposed, under appeal (2025)	Under appeal	NO CHANGE

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Nigeria Tax Act 2025 and Tax Administration Act 2025	In force (2025)	The statutory base for the virtual-asset tax circular	NO CHANGE

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Draft National Policy on Data and Cloud	In draft (2021)	Five years a draft, while the localisation question was settled by circular instead	NO CHANGE
Artificial Intelligence and Cyber Diplomacy Unit	BASELINE NOT HELD	Unit inside the Ministry of Foreign Affairs coordinating engagement on emerging technologies	Baseline not held

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Abuja Declaration on Meaningful Connectivity	Did not exist	Adopted with machinery to argue the position at the ITU	ADVANCED
Digital Trade Regulators' Working Group	Did not exist	Nigeria-led group harmonising market entry, licensing and regulatory cooperation; no output published	ADVANCED
Global CBPR Forum membership	Member (2025-04)	Member	NO CHANGE

Data protection

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
AI-enabled online gender-based violence tracker	Did not exist	Live, with more than 20,000 verified cases already documented at launch	ADVANCED
America First Global Health Strategy MOU	Did not exist	Signed 2025-12-19; US\$1,953,530,560 planned United States support against Nigeria's US\$2,975,634,499	ADVANCED
Civil-society enforcement against a public body	Did not exist	A Federal High Court suit against the electoral commission	ADVANCED
Federal Government circular on MDA data-protection compliance	Did not exist	Every MDA must appoint a data protection officer registered with the NDPC, budget for compliance and file audit returns, with accounting officers personally responsible	ADVANCED
Meta-funded data-protection capacity programme	Did not exist	A two-year programme funded under a court-approved settlement	ADVANCED
NDPC and NCC data-protection MoU	Did not exist	Cooperation between the two regulators	ADVANCED
NDPC enforcement regime	Compliance about 55% (2025-03)	Remediation-first enforcement, compliance above 55%	ADVANCED
NDPC investigations of multinational platforms	Did not exist	Multinational platforms under investigation	ADVANCED
United States-Nigeria Specimen Sharing Agreement	Did not exist	In force 2026-01-18, five-year term renewable once	ADVANCED
MultiChoice data-protection penalty	Imposed (2025-07)	The largest NDPC fine; whether it was paid is not established	NO CHANGE
Nigeria Data Protection Act 2023	In force (2023)	In force; the Commission sits under ministerial control	NO CHANGE

One position worsened and the rest of the section arrived.

Internet-platform regulation regressed: enforcement of new rules was paused in July pending a unified national digital-economy policy framework. The same month's competition directive put the same class of company under investigation for abuse of dominance.

Data-protection enforcement held its band and changed character within it: already active at the window's start, having lifted compliance from about 4% to 55%+ by March 2025, what the year added was judicial confirmation. The Federal High Court upheld the Commission's registration power in July, and days later a private claimant won the first damages award under the Act without needing the Commission at all. Neither judgment is held, and one has no established delivery date.

What arrived: an executive order that creates a coordination council rather than a regulator, and a tax framework that collects duty in the token. The two rows that held position throughout are the statute itself and the 2021 draft data and cloud policy — five years a draft, while the localisation question it was written to answer was settled instead by a central bank circular.

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Risk-based AI regime in the digital-economy bill	Did not exist	High-risk systems would face annual impact assessments; the bill is not passed	ADVANCED

Standards

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Migration of government identity to the .gov.ng domain	Did not exist	Government identity still exposed on foreign domains	ADVANCED

Access to services

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Agent-network microfinance	BASELINE NOT HELD	Agent-network microfinance for microenterprises and the unbanked	Baseline not held

AI

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
AI governance framework for tertiary institutions	Did not exist	NUC framework written and the three tertiary regulators committed to harmonise; the text is not held	ADVANCED
N-ATLAS sovereign multilingual model	Did not exist	Open-source and multimodal across four Nigerian languages, on Llama-3 8B	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Proposed responsible-AI governance framework for public bodies	Did not exist	An independent proposal, not a government instrument	ADVANCED
Responsible AI in Finance Hub	Did not exist	Proposed over an installed base: 87.5% of surveyed fintechs already use AI for fraud detection	ADVANCED
National AI Strategy and the National AI Trust	Approved (2025-02)	The strategy itself still in development	NO CHANGE

ICT Industry

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Embedded insurance infrastructure	Did not exist	Open to banks, fintechs, employers and merchants	ADVANCED
Enterprise AI distribution through institutions	Did not exist	Distributed through universities and professional communities	ADVANCED
Airtel AI spam detection	Live (2025-03)	Live	NO CHANGE

Innovation ecosystem

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Katsina state technology hub	Did not exist	Planned	ADVANCED
NCC Digital Industrial Park and Learning Centre lease to Enugu State	Did not exist	Two federal facilities transferred to state operation for 15 years, to run as the Enugu Talent City and an AI institute	ADVANCED
Itana digital free zone	Live (2025-06)	Remote incorporation on a US\$100m phase-1 commitment	NO CHANGE
JICA startup hub programme	Running (2025-06)	US\$11.2m startup hub plus US\$40m for social-startup support	NO CHANGE

US / hyperscaler activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Google AI alliance, research and skilling	Alliance signed (2025-02)	A five-area alliance plus ₦3bn across five partners	ADVANCED

China activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Huawei Lagos innovation centre	Open (2025-05)	Framed by the minister as a catalyst for tech sovereignty	NO CHANGE
AI surveillance estate	BASELINE NOT HELD	Above US\$470m on facial recognition and number-plate tracking, the continent's largest (2026-03)	Baseline not held

Training and skills

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Deep-technology teaching laboratories in a private university	Did not exist	Planned; lab count, cost and funding not stated	ADVANCED
Microsoft AI training commitment	Committed (2025-02)	US\$1 a trainee, which drew feasibility scepticism	NO CHANGE
Talent-export platform partnership	Running (2025-04)	Running	NO CHANGE

Rural digital data capture

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Cisco AI for smallholder farmers	Did not exist	Exploratory; no programme, funding, timeline or counterparty ministry named	ADVANCED

Digitalisation of sub-national government

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Cross River Smart Surveillance Infrastructure Project	Did not exist	Phase One approved for a Huawei-specified facial-recognition and plate-recognition network feeding a command centre in the Office of the State Security Adviser	ADVANCED
AI open-contracting platform in three states	Live (2025-02)	Running in three states	NO CHANGE
Anambra SmartGov	Live (2025-06)	Flagged ₦2.1bn unspent and detected ghost workers	NO CHANGE
Lagos Ask INU survivor-support chatbot	Live (2025-02)	Live	NO CHANGE

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Credit scoring from payment traces	Did not exist	Scores people without bank accounts from payment traces and sells the output to banks	ADVANCED

No system in this section changed band, and the governing instrument is still inside a bill.

What arrived: the sovereign multilingual model in September 2025; the risk-based regime's public timeline in January 2026; a proposed governance framework for public-sector AI in June, which asks first for an inventory of what is already running; the central bank's Responsible AI in Finance Hub, proposed over an [installed base of 87.5% of surveyed fintechs](#) already using AI for fraud detection.

What held position: the national strategy and trust, the hyperscaler skilling commitments, and the state deployments. All were in place before the window opened and none moved.

The surveillance estate carries no baseline the base can state: the largest AI deployment in the country by expenditure — [above US\\$470m](#) on facial recognition and number-plate tracking, with about 10,000 cameras — cannot be dated at either end of a twelve-month window, and the research finding attached to it is that there is little evidence it reduces crime.

Inclusion and capacity

Digital divides

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Device affordability	BASELINE NOT HELD	A global memory-chip shortage turning device cost into a divide variable (2026-07)	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Gender gap in identity enrolment	BASELINE NOT HELD	38.8% of enrolled NIN holders are women against 61.1% men, a 22.3-point gap (2025-06)	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Access to services

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
Zero-rated access to education platforms	Did not exist	Every option consulted on requires registration to control access	ADVANCED
Financial inclusion	BASELINE NOT HELD	74% financially included (2023), against a 95% target for 2028	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Training and skills

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
AI Teacher Capacity Development Programme	A pilot in six unity colleges	Contracted for national rollout to about 11,700 teachers across all Federal Unity Colleges	ADVANCED
Huawei and NCCE Digital Academy for teacher-training colleges	Did not exist	A vendor Digital Academy established at the commission that accredits teacher-training colleges, with the college curriculum revised to add AI and robotics, networking and cybersecurity, data science and analytics, and software and web development	ADVANCED
Lagos teacher AI literacy programme	Did not exist	Entering the classroom through teachers rather than the curriculum	ADVANCED
Mastercard Foundation EdTech Fellowship	Running since its 2019 launch	Twelve startups in cohort 4; 72 companies supported since 2019	ADVANCED, FOURTH COHORT
Data-protection officer certification pipeline	Running (2025-05)	Aimed at an informal sector that is 65% of employment	NO CHANGE

The section's one movement is a delivery failure. A state programme to build 260 schools, one in every ward, powered by solar and connected before instruction was layered on, promised full opening of all 260 in January 2026. [By May 2026 many were incomplete and unequipped](#) with pupils already resuming. The stated sequencing was power first, then connectivity, then teaching; the schedule was not met.

Everything else here either arrived or held. Arrivals were a zero-rated education consultation, an AI-literacy programme entering schools through teachers and a ministerial declaration on meaningful connectivity; the skills and inclusion programmes all held.

The measurements are baselines rather than movements: [rural access at 23% against 57% urban](#), women at 38.8% of enrolled identity holders, and correction of register errors routed through a smartphone portal in a country where about 72% of adults have no smartphone. None is re-measured inside the window.

Finance

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-04	MOVEMENT
iDICE debt financing for technology startups	Did not exist	US\$110m of debt financing open	ADVANCED
Telecoms foreign direct investment	US\$107.46m (2021 low)	US\$392.91m in the first nine months of 2025, the strongest since 2019	ADVANCED

[iDICE opened US\\$110m of debt financing for technology startups](#) for applications on 2026-07-30, the section's one financing-instrument arrival in the period.

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Hyperscaler cloud region in Nigeria	An AWS, Azure or Google Cloud announcement of a Nigerian cloud region or local availability zone, or a ministerial statement of terms offered to secure one.	2026-08-04
Power sequencing plan for the data-localisation deadline	A CBN, NITDA or Ministry of Power statement sequencing grid and data-centre capacity milestones against the 2027-01-01 localisation deadline.	2026-08-04
Public breach disclosure regime	An NDPC or NCC rule requiring breach notifications to be published, or an annual register of notified breaches naming the controllers involved.	2026-08-04
Published interoperability framework under the NIMC Act 2026	A gazetted regulation or published framework stating the lawful basis, consent mechanism, retention rule and audit arrangements for inter-agency sharing of identity data — or the gazetted text of the Act itself.	2026-08-04
Whether foreign cloud local zones satisfy the localisation directive	A CBN clarification, FAQ or supervisory letter stating whether a hyperscaler's in-country availability zone meets the storage-and-management requirement of circular PSS/DIR/PUB/CIR/001/004.	2026-08-04
Consolidated federal budget allocation to digital transformation	A Budget Office appropriation extract or Ministry of Communications, Innovation and Digital Economy annual report carrying total digital and ICT spend across votes.	2026-08-04
India-Nigeria digital cooperation	A bilateral MoU, India Stack or DPI cooperation programme document, or a ministerial readout naming a Nigeria-India digital instrument.	2026-08-04

Seven subjects carry no reliable position at either end, all probed once on 2026-08-04. Three became acquisition lines: the gazetted identity statute, the 2026 appropriation vote for the digital-economy ministry, and a cooperation memorandum with India's electronics ministry.

Four absences stand dated, and three of them converge on 2027-01-01. No hyperscaler cloud region or local availability zone has been announced; no government instrument sequences grid capacity against the localisation deadline; and whether a foreign cloud's in-country zone satisfies the directive is the question the circular does not answer. The fourth is the absence of any published register of notified data breaches.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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